



TraderLab 101

Quick Start

V2.3.17 · MAY 2026

If this — then that. If not — then what?

— Tom B., Traders Lab

Version 2.3.15 · Get going in about 15 minutes

This guide takes you from "first download" to "logged a trade and looked at analytics" without the long-form theory. For everything else, see [USERGUIDE.md](#).

What You're About To Do

1. Download & open (1 min)
2. Set your instrument (1 min)
3. Load demo data (1 min) ← fastest way to see the app full of data
4. Walk through a session
 - └ Preflight (2 min)
 - └ Pre-Market Levels (3 min)
 - └ Confirm Open Type (1 min)
 - └ Log a trade (3 min)
 - └ Save the journal (2 min)
5. Look at Analytics (2 min)
6. Back up your data (30 sec)

Step 1 — Download & Open

1. Go to the [GitHub repository](#)
2. Download `TraderLab101.html`
3. Save it anywhere on your computer
4. Double-click to open in **Chrome** (recommended)

No installation. No accounts. No server. Your data stays on your machine.

On first launch you will see two one-time splash screens:

1. **Welcome splash** — read it, click **Let's Get to Work** →
2. **Service & Support Terms** — read carefully. Tick the agreement checkbox to enable the **I Understand and Agree — Continue** → button. In short: bug fixes are at the developer's discretion (no obligation); **what counts as a bug, an enhancement, or a feature request is solely the developer's call** (and that classification decides whether it's free or billable); the tool itself is free but the developer's time is not, so any custom request or add-on built for you specifically carries a **minimum service fee of \$100.00 USD per request** to compensate the developer's time (scope-dependent, agreed in writing first). **Each fee covers that single request only** — not future versions, ongoing maintenance, or priority support. Standard releases remain free under the existing license.

You only need to agree once per browser.

Step 2 — Set Your Instrument

Click ⚙ **Settings** at the bottom of the left nav, then click the **INSTRUMENT** link in the sticky header.

Click your preset:

Preset	Tick	Tick Value	Default Commission (RT)
MES	0.25 pt	\$1.25	~\$0.62
ES	0.25 pt	\$12.50	~\$4.18
MNQ	0.25 pt	\$0.50	~\$0.62
NQ	0.25 pt	\$5.00	~\$4.18

Adjust the commission to match your broker. That's it for setup.

Trading multiple symbols? *TraderLab is cleanest when each log is one instrument. The simplest pattern: one JSON backup per symbol (e.g. `Sean_NQ_2026.json`, `Sean_ES_2026.json`) and switch with Settings → DATA → Export/Import. If you'd rather keep them all in one log, that works too — the Trade Log will show a per-symbol summary chip row and the Analytics tab has an **Instrument filter** that scopes every chart to one symbol at a time. Full guide: [MULTI_SYMBOL_NOTES.md](#) (PDF in repo).*

Trading a custom symbol? (RTY, YM, CL, GC, BTC, etc.) Define it in **Settings** → **Custom Symbol** with tick size, tick value, AND commission. The commission field is required — the app blocks save without it so analytics never silently use \$0 fees. There's also an optional **Yahoo Symbol** field for the live-price fallback (`YM=F`, `RTY=F`, `CL=F`, `BTC=USD`, etc.) — leave blank to auto-derive.

Step 3 — Load Demo Data (Optional but Highly Recommended)

The fastest way to see the app at full strength is to load the demo data.

1. In the same **Settings** panel, scroll to **DATA**
2. Click ↑ **Import Backup**
3. Select `traderlab-demo-trades.json` (in the same folder as the HTML)

You now have **61 sessions, 220 trades, and 41 missed trades** to explore. Skip to **Step 7** if you want to look at the analytics first, then come back here for a real session walkthrough.

When you're ready to start fresh, **Settings** → **DATA** → ✕ **Clear Everything**.

Step 4 — Preflight (2 min)

Click ➤ **Preflight** in the left nav. Answer at least three of the eight pre-session questions:

1. What is the Opening Context?
2. What is the HTF Context?
3. What did we do in the previous RTH session?
4. What did we do in the ETH/Overnight session?
5. Where are the stops/fuel?
6. Based on where the fuel is — who is offside?
7. Any news or data events?
8. Top-down analysis — your overall read

Click ☒ **Complete Preflight** when done. Your answers are stamped with a timestamp and attached to today's journal automatically.

Step 5 — Pre-Market Levels (3 min)

Click ⚙ **Pre-Market Levels**. Three ways to get your levels in:

Method	How
BMBridge	Enter URL → click Import
CSV File	Click Choose CSV File → select
Type them in	Just fill the boxes manually

Fill in at minimum:

- **Prior Day:** pHigh, pLow, pClose, pVPOC
- **Value Area:** pVAH, pVAL
- **Overnight + Today's Open:** ONH, ONL, Today's Open

Then set your **bias** at the top — click ▲ **LONG**, — **NEUTRAL**, or ▼ **SHORT**. Add a sentence for *why*.

Optional: add **Fuel Levels** at the bottom (places where participants are trapped). Click + **Add Fuel Level** for each.

The **Open Type** auto-detects from your levels. When you're happy with it, click  **Confirm Open Type** to lock it in. This activates the rest of the app.

Step 6 — Live Price & a First Trade (3 min)

Click  **Live Price** to see the live feed. If BMBridge isn't configured, the feed falls back to Yahoo Finance (~15 minute delay) — fine for getting a feel.

When you take a trade, click  **Trade Log** and fill in:

1. **Date / Time / Setup / Direction / Entry / Stop**
2. **Scale 1 — Risk Neutral** — exit price + contracts
3. **Scale 2 — Target** — exit price + contracts
4. **Runner / Final Exit** — final exit + contracts
5. *(Optional)* Click + **Add Scale** to insert extra intermediate Target legs between Scale 2 and the Runner — any number. Each added row has its own ✕ Remove button and labels auto-renumber.
6. Click any **target chip** (DVPOC, VWAP, MID, etc.) and mark the outcome — ✓ Hit, ↩ Bailed, or ✕ Missed
7. **Process Rating** — A / B / C / F (be honest)
8. **Exit Time** — for duration tracking
9. Optional: tag any **execution errors** and **emotional state** chips

Click **Log Trade**. You'll see:

- A new row in the trade list below
 - Your stat cards update at the top
 - A toast confirmation
-

Step 7 — Save the Journal (2 min)

Click  **Journal**. Today's date is auto-selected.

Most fields are pre-filled from your session:

- Open Type — auto from confirmed session
- Preflight answers — auto from completed Preflight
- Bias timeline — auto from Pre-Market

Add the human-context fields:

- **Day Type / Profile Shape** — what kind of day did it become?
- **Session Result** — Win / Loss / Break Even / No Trade
- **IB Outcome / Market Responsive** — quick characterization
- **Key Levels Traded**
- **Trade Notes / Auction Story** — what happened, in your own words
- **Lesson** — one sentence you want to remember

Click **Save Session**. You can always come back later — past dates open in **review mode** with a clean read-only summary.

Draft auto-save (v2.3.15): As you type into the journal, every field auto-saves silently. A small "✓ **Draft saved**" indicator appears in the Session Entry header when a draft is active. If you close the browser before hitting Save Session, your draft restores automatically the next time you open the journal. Click the "✕ **discard**" link next to the indicator to throw away the in-progress draft and start fresh. (This protection covers the Journal only — the Trade Log and Missed Trade forms still need an explicit Save click before closing.)

Step 8 — Look at Analytics (2 min)

Click  **Analytics**. The dashboard auto-renders from your data.

What to look at first:

Card / Section	What It Tells You
Win Rate	Are you net positive on count?
Profit Factor	Are your wins big enough relative to losses?
P&L by Setup	Which setups actually pay you?
P&L by Time of Day	When are you sharp vs. tired?
Tilt Detection	Did you have any revenge / overtrade days?
P&L by Bias Alignment	Do you make money trading with your bias?

Use the date-range filter at the top (All , 1W , 1M , 2M , 3M , 6M , YTD , Custom) to scope the dashboard.

Step 9 — Back Up Your Data (30 sec)

Settings → DATA → ↓ Export Backup

Saves a timestamped JSON file. Do this **at least weekly**. If you ever clear browser cache, this file is your only way back.

A user's data must never be lost. The app is built to read backups from any prior version — restore is always available.

Where To Go Next

If you want to...	Open
Read the full reference for every panel	USERGUIDE.md
Read the trading methodology	 Methodology in the left nav
Try simulated changes ("what if I cut C-rated trades?")	 What-If Lab
Get personalized AI coaching from your trade history	 AI Coach (free copy-prompt mode, or in-app via Anthropic API key)
See the changelog and known issues	CHANGELOG.md
Report a bug or request a feature	GitHub Issues
Discuss a custom request / add-on (service fee, \$100 USD min per request)	sdes.dev · sean@sdes.dev

A Few Habits That Make TraderLab Pay Off

1. **Do Preflight every day, even if it's two sentences.** The data feeds the journal and analytics.
2. **Rate your process honestly.** A C-rated win is more dangerous than a B-rated loss.
3. **Log missed trades.** Hesitation patterns are the loudest signal in the data.
4. **Export weekly.** Five seconds. Save your work.
5. **Look at analytics on weekends, not during the session.** Decisions during the trade should come from your plan, not from the dashboard.

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